

HEALING FOR THE HOMES SERIES

# TRUSTING GOD AFTER DIVORCE

He makes all things  
beautiful in His time.

— ECCLESIASTES 3:11



Overcomers  
Global Network

EDUCATE . EQUIP . EVOLVE

BY PROPHET JOSHUA MATTHEWS

## DEDICATION

*This booklet is dedicated to the one who stood at an altar and meant every word — and watched it all come apart anyway. Divorce was never your dream. But God still is. He has not abandoned you because your marriage ended. He is standing right here, ready to rebuild your life, your faith, and your future.*

## A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER

Dear friend,

I want to begin with something the church often fails to say to divorced believers: I am sorry for your pain. Whatever happened — whoever was at fault — divorce is a devastating loss, and you deserve compassion, not condemnation.

The church has sometimes treated divorced people like second-class citizens in the Kingdom of God. That is not the heart of Jesus. He came for the wounded, the broken, the ones whose lives did not go as planned. And if you are holding this booklet, you are exactly the kind of person He is reaching for right now.

This is not a booklet about whether divorce is right or wrong. This is a booklet about what happens next — how you trust a God who allowed your marriage to end, how you rebuild your identity when half of who you were has been torn away, and how you let Christ heal what feels unhealable. You are not disqualified. You are being redirected.

*With all my love in Christ,*

*Joshua Matthews*

*Founder, Overcomers Global Network*

## The Cry of the Soul

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There is a particular loneliness that comes with divorce. It is not the same as being single — because you were not always single. You were someone's husband. Someone's wife. You had a home with two names on the mailbox and a future that included another person.

And then it unraveled. Maybe slowly, over years of growing apart. Maybe suddenly, with a confession that shattered everything in a single sentence. Maybe through betrayal. Maybe through mutual exhaustion. Maybe through abuse that left you no choice but to leave in order to survive.

However it happened, the result is the same: you are standing in the rubble of a covenant, and you are not sure how to rebuild.

The legal process may be over. The papers may be signed. But the emotional process is still raging. You wake up reaching for someone who is not there. You instinctively buy groceries for two. You hear a song and it detonates a memory that brings you to your knees. And then there are the children — if there are children — whose confused eyes and impossible questions make the pain exponentially worse.

And through all of this, there is a crisis of faith happening beneath the surface. You prayed for this marriage. You fasted for it. You believed God would save it. And He didn't — or at least it doesn't look like He did. And now you are left with a question that feels dangerous to even whisper: *"God, where were You?"*

Let me tell you where He was. He was right where He has always been — on the throne, with His eyes on you, working in ways you could not see. And He is here now, in these pages, ready to help you trust Him again.

## What the Bible Says

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I want to address something directly: God is not angry at you for being divorced. I know there are scriptures about God hating divorce (Malachi 2:16), and that verse has been used like a weapon against wounded people who are already carrying more guilt than they can bear. But let me show you the full picture.

God hates divorce the way a surgeon hates amputation — not because he hates the patient, but because he hates that the procedure is necessary. God hates divorce because He hates the pain it causes. He hates the broken homes, the weeping children, the shattered trust. He does not hate *you*. He hurts *for* you.

Consider this: God Himself is described in Scripture as having experienced a type of divorce. He speaks of unfaithful Israel:

*""Then I saw that for all the causes for which backsliding Israel had committed adultery, I had put her away and given her a certificate of divorce.""*

— **Jeremiah 3:8 (NKJV)**

God understands the pain of covenant betrayal. He has experienced it — not because of any failure on His part, but because of the unfaithfulness of the other party. If you are the one who was betrayed, God knows exactly what you feel. He has been where you are.

And even after the "divorce," God did not abandon Israel. He pursued. He restored. He made a new covenant through Christ. The story was not over.

*""For the mountains shall depart and the hills be removed, but My kindness shall not depart from you, nor shall My covenant of peace be removed,' says the Lord, who has mercy on you.""*

— **Isaiah 54:10 (NKJV)**

His covenant of peace with you is still intact. Your marriage may have ended, but His commitment to you has not.

The woman at the well in John chapter 4 had been through five marriages. Five. And she was currently living with a man who was not her

husband. By every religious standard of that day, she was the last person Jesus should have spoken to.

But Jesus went out of His way to meet her. The Bible says He "needed to go through Samaria" (John 4:4) — not because it was the most logical route, but because she was there. He rearranged His journey to reach a divorced, broken, culturally rejected woman sitting by a well at noon, hiding from the rest of the village.

And He did not bring up her past to shame her. He brought it up to show her that He already knew everything about her — and He was still there, offering her living water.

*""Jesus answered and said to her, 'Whoever drinks of this water will thirst again, but whoever drinks of the water that I shall give him will never thirst. But the water that I shall give him will become in him a fountain of water springing up into everlasting life.'""*

— John 4:13–14 (NKJV)

That woman left the well and went back to the same village she had been hiding from and told everyone about Jesus. She became an evangelist — a woman with five divorces became a vessel for revival. Do not tell me God cannot use you after divorce. He just used her to reach an entire city.

## The Root of the Pain

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**Identity Crisis.** Marriage merges two identities into one. When that bond is severed, you often feel like you have lost yourself. Who are you outside of that relationship? What is your purpose now? Where do you belong?

This identity crisis is one of the most disorienting aspects of divorce. Research shows that divorced individuals often experience a phenomenon called "self-concept disruption" — a period where their sense of who they are becomes unstable. This can lead to depression, loss of direction, and a deep sense of purposelessness.

**Grief.** Divorce is a death — the death of a relationship, a dream, a future that will never be. And like all deaths, it must be grieved. But society often does not give divorced people permission to grieve. There is no funeral, no cards, no casseroles on the porch. You are expected to "move on." But your heart is in mourning, and it needs time.

**Shame in the Church.** For many believers, the hardest part of divorce is not the loss of the marriage — it is the loss of belonging in the church. You feel judged. You feel whispered about. You feel like a cautionary tale instead of a person. Some churches treat divorced people as though they are permanently damaged goods.

But Jesus never treated broken people that way. He ate with sinners. He touched lepers. He spoke to the Samaritan woman. His arms were always widest for the ones the religious world pushed away.

**Trust Damage.** After divorce, your ability to trust is severely wounded — not just in romantic relationships, but in friendships, in church leadership, and even in God. If the person who vowed "til death do us part" could leave, how can you trust anyone to stay? If God didn't save your marriage, how can you trust Him with your future?

This is the deepest wound: the fracture in your relationship with God. And it needs the most tender, patient healing.

*""Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He shall direct your paths.""*

— Proverbs 3:5–6 (NKJV)

Trusting God after divorce does not mean pretending the pain isn't there. It means choosing — daily, sometimes hourly — to believe that God is still good, still faithful, and still working, even when the evidence feels thin.

## Christ's Healing Power

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God calls Himself by a name in Isaiah 54 that is specifically meant for people in your situation:

*""For your Maker is your husband, the Lord of hosts is His name; and your Redeemer is the Holy One of Israel; He is called the God of the whole earth. For the Lord has called you like a woman forsaken and grieved in spirit, like a youthful wife when you were refused.""*

— **Isaiah 54:5–6 (NKJV)**

"Your Maker is your husband." God is not just your creator. He is your covering. He is your partner. He is the One who will never walk out, never betray, never file papers. When every other covenant fails, His covenant stands.

And look at what He says next:

*""For a mere moment I have forsaken you, but with great mercies I will gather you. With a little wrath I hid My face from you for a moment; but with everlasting kindness I will have mercy on you.""*

— **Isaiah 54:7–8 (NKJV)**

A moment. That is what God calls your season of pain — a moment. Not because it doesn't feel like forever, but because compared to the everlasting kindness that is coming, it is a blink. The pain is temporary. His mercy is permanent.

God is rebuilding your life right now. Brick by brick, day by day. You may not see the structure yet, but He sees the blueprint. And it is beautiful.

*""'For I know the plans I have for you,' declares the Lord, 'plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future.'""*

— **Jeremiah 29:11 (NIV)**

He has plans — present tense, active, ongoing — for your life. Divorce did not cancel them. It redirected them.

## Healing Prayers

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## **A Prayer for Healing After Divorce**

*Father God, I come to You with the broken pieces of my marriage in my hands. I lay them at Your feet. I cannot put them back together. I don't know if I even should. But I know that You can make something new from the wreckage. Heal my heart. Heal my identity. Heal the part of me that feels like a failure. Remind me that my value is not determined by my marital status — it is determined by Your love. In Jesus' name, amen.*

## **A Prayer for the Children**

*Lord, I pray for my children. They did not choose this. They are confused, they are hurting, and they need You more than ever. Be their stability when everything feels unstable. Be their comfort when they cry. Protect their hearts from bitterness, from blame, and from the enemy's lies. Help me to parent them with grace, patience, and wisdom, even on the days when I feel like I am barely surviving myself. Cover them, Lord. In Jesus' name, amen.*

## **A Prayer to Trust God Again**

*Father, trusting You right now feels almost impossible. I trusted You with my marriage and it fell apart. I trusted You with my future and it looks nothing like I imagined. Lord, I am not angry — I am afraid. Afraid to trust again. Afraid to hope again. But Your Word says to trust You with all my heart. Help me, Lord. Rebuild my trust brick by brick. Show me Your faithfulness in small things so I can believe it in big things. I choose You again today. I choose to trust even when I am afraid. In Jesus' name, amen.*

## **Prophetic Declarations**

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**"My divorce is not the end of my story. God is writing a new chapter."**

**"My Maker is my husband. I am not alone."**

**"God's plans for me are still good — plans for hope and a future."**

**"I am not a failure. I am a child of God being restored."**

**"My children are covered by the hand of God."**

**"Trust is being rebuilt in me — slowly, steadily, by the Holy Spirit."**

**"Shame has no claim on me. I am forgiven and free."**

**"God's everlasting kindness is overtaking the pain of this season."**

**"I will love again — wisely, purely, and led by the Spirit."**

**"My identity is not 'divorced.' My identity is 'beloved.'"**

## **Reflection & Healing**

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### **Reflect on These Questions**

1. What is the hardest part of your divorce experience — the loss, the loneliness, the shame, the identity crisis, or something else?
2. Have you given yourself permission to grieve the end of your marriage? If not, what is stopping you?
3. Has your view of God changed since the divorce? If so, how?
4. What lie have you believed about yourself since the divorce? Write it down, then write the truth from Scripture next to it.
5. What does rebuilding look like for you? Not a new relationship — but a new sense of self, purpose, and trust in God?
6. What is one thing you are grateful for today, even in the middle of this pain?

Beloved, divorce may have ended your marriage, but it did not end your value, your calling, or your relationship with God. He is still for you. He is still with you. And He is building something new on the other side of this valley. Keep walking. He goes before you.

## A CLOSING PRAYER

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*Father, I bring before You this precious soul who has walked through the valley of divorce. Lord, You know the weight they carry — the grief, the guilt, the loneliness, the questions. You know the nights they've spent wondering what they could have done differently. You know the shame they've felt sitting in church alone.*

*Lord, I ask You right now to wrap Your arms around them. Tell them what You told Israel: "I will never leave you nor forsake you." Heal the wound of the covenant that was broken. Restore their sense of identity. Rebuild their trust — in You and in the future You have planned for them.*

*I decree that their story does not end with divorce. I decree that new beginnings are coming. I decree that God is faithful even when people are not. In Jesus' name, amen.*

## AN INVITATION TO CHRIST

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*If you have never given your life to Jesus Christ, or if divorce has caused you to walk away, come home. He is not keeping score. He is keeping the door open. Pray: "Lord Jesus, I am broken and I need a new start. I believe You died for me and rose again. Forgive my sins. Come into my life. Be my Lord, my healer, and my constant. I give You my past, my present, and my future. In Jesus' name, amen."*

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# TRUSTING GOD AFTER DIVORCE

Divorce leaves behind grief, confusion, loneliness, and many spiritual questions. This booklet offers compassion to the one trying to rebuild after a painful ending. Through scripture, honest encouragement, and healing prayer, Joshua Matthews helps the reader trust God again and move forward with hope, dignity, and restored faith.

*God can still rebuild what pain has  
tried to take from you.*



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